

The OECD Working Group on Bribery in International Business Transactions

2025 Annual Report

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Message from the Chair



The fight against foreign bribery is central to safeguarding fair competition and sustaining trust in global markets. For more than 25 years, the OECD Anti-Bribery Convention (the Convention) has provided a powerful framework for confronting cross-border corruption. Through rigorous monitoring and peer accountability, the OECD Working Group on Bribery (WGB) has helped drive stronger enforcement of anti-bribery laws and ensure that countries deliver on their commitments under the Convention.

My first full year as Chair of the WGB was a year of meaningful growth. The WGB welcomed Ukraine as its 47th member,¹ extending the Convention's reach at a moment when strong public institutions and the rule of law are under pressure in many parts of the world. Further demonstrating continued global demand for a rules-based approach to combating foreign bribery, three additional countries, Indonesia, Mauritius and Thailand, formally requested accession to the Convention, and a fourth, Saudi Arabia, has undertaken several reforms to align with the Convention. This growing community strengthens international co-operation in complex, cross-border cases, and helps ensure that companies operate under coherent and predictable rules wherever they do business.

As Chair, I have made it a priority to ensure that the WGB functions with discipline and impact. To this end, we have introduced improvements to support more productive, outcome-driven discussions. An area of focus has been our Tour de Table, where members report on foreign bribery investigations, prosecutions and sanctions, complementing the WGB's regular monitoring exercise. By sharpening the structure and expectations of the Tour de Table, we reinforce the WGB's accountability function and strengthen its ability to drive meaningful enforcement progress.

This work is essential considering the latest enforcement data, which tracks how countries have been enforcing anti-bribery laws since the Convention's entry into force in 1999 through 2024. The data show that while enforcement has continued steadily, it remains uneven across countries, with 16 countries having yet to report a single conviction or sanction for foreign bribery. This is a clear reminder that much work remains to be done, and that decisive government leadership is crucial to close persistent enforcement gaps.

Looking ahead, the WGB is preparing for the design of its next monitoring cycle. This is an opportunity to reflect on lessons learned, adapt our approach to an evolving risk environment, and ensure that monitoring remains robust and relevant. As part of this process, we will hold a multi-stakeholder public consultation in June 2026 to gather the views of those who rely most directly on effective enforcement. Civil society plays a critical role in promoting transparency and holding authorities to account, while business has a strong stake in clear, consistently enforced rules that support fair competition. Their perspectives will help us set priorities that strengthen the Convention's impact in practice.

¹ Ukraine became the 47th member of the WGB in December 2025. As of the publication of this report, Ukraine's ratification of and deposit of its instrument of accession to the Convention are pending.

In today's complex global landscape, the WGB stands as an essential resource for members and non-members, providing guidance, expertise, and a forum for collaboration. By continuing to strengthen our processes and designing the next monitoring cycle with attention to gaps, emerging risks, and stakeholder expectations, we will position the WGB to drive more consistent and effective implementation of the Convention and ensure that it remains at the forefront of the global fight against foreign bribery.

Kathleen Roussel

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Acronyms

ADB	Asian Development Bank
ACI	Anti-Corruption Initiative for Asia and the Pacific
ACN	Anti-Corruption Network for Eastern Europe and Central Asia
ACWG	Anti-Corruption Working Group
AfDB	African Development Bank
BIAC	Business at the OECD
BIN	Business Integrity Network
EC	European Commission
EPPO	European Public Prosecutors Office
FATF	Financial Action Task Force
GACIF	Global Anti-Corruption and Integrity Forum
GLEN	Global Law Enforcement Network
GRECO	Group of States Against Corruption
GRSD	Global Relations Strategic Directions
IACCC	International Anti-Corruption Coordination Centre
LEN	Law Enforcement Network
LEO	Law enforcement officials
MENA	Middle East and North Africa
MOBIN	MENA-OECD Business Integrity Network
PWB	Programme of Work and Budget
OECD	Organisation for Economic Co-operation and Development
UNODC	United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime
WGB	Working Group on Bribery in International Business Transactions

1 The OECD Anti-Bribery Convention and the Working Group on Bribery

The OECD Anti-Bribery Convention

By compromising fair competition and weakening market integrity, corruption inflates the cost of doing business and constrains economic growth. The [Convention](#) (OECD, 1997^[1]) sets out legally binding commitments requiring Parties to criminalise the bribery of foreign public officials in international business transactions and implement a comprehensive framework to ensure those obligations are effective in practice. This framework includes holding both companies and individuals accountable; imposing sanctions that are effective, proportionate and dissuasive; and providing mutual legal assistance in foreign bribery cases. The Convention is unique in its focus on disrupting the “supply side” of transnational corruption.

To date, 46 countries – the 38 OECD member countries and eight non-member countries: Argentina, Brazil, Bulgaria, Croatia, Peru, Romania, the Russian Federation,² and South Africa and – have [acceded to the Convention](#). Accession to the Convention is open to any country that aligns with key requirements of the Convention and is willing to become a full Participant in the WGB, in accordance with the WGB’s accession procedures. The Convention is complemented by the [OECD Anti-Bribery Recommendation](#) (Anti-Bribery Recommendation) (OECD, 2021^[2]) and related instruments, and it focuses on the prevention, detection, investigation, prosecution and sanctioning of the bribery of foreign public officials in international business transactions.

The Working Group on Bribery

Composed of representatives from all 46 Parties to the Convention, the [WGB](#) oversees implementation of the Convention, the Anti-Bribery Recommendation and related instruments. It operates a rigorous peer-review monitoring system conducted in successive phases (outlined in detail in Chapter 3). Through this monitoring mechanism, the Convention has become one of the most stringently enforced international anti-corruption instruments. The WGB makes its [country monitoring reports](#) publicly available, along with the [public summaries of its meetings](#).

² In April 2022, in response to the Russian Federation’s illegal war of aggression against Ukraine, the OECD Council suspended the participation of the Russian Federation in the Working Group on Bribery except for monitoring pursuant to Article 12 of the Convention on Combating Bribery of Foreign Public Officials in International Business Transactions.



The WGB is committed to upholding high standards and promoting effective practices for preventing, detecting and enforcing foreign bribery offences. It works with non-members, other OECD bodies, international organisations, the private sector and civil society. Its established network of law enforcement officials (LEO) meets twice annually alongside WGB meetings to exchange experience, refine good practices, and consider practical challenges in investigating and prosecuting foreign bribery cases. The WGB also maintains dialogue with civil society representatives and sponsors outreach events hosted at the OECD.

The WGB, December 2025

2 Summaries of Working Group on Bribery meetings and related events

Given its mandate to monitor the implementation and enforcement of the Convention, the Anti-Bribery Recommendation and related instruments, the WGB maintains a rigorous programme of work. This includes taking additional measures where non-compliance with the Convention is identified. The summaries below provide an overview of the WGB's 2025 meetings. [Public summary records](#) of all WGB meetings are available on the OECD website.

Meeting of the Working Group on Bribery, March 2025

The WGB adopted the Phase 4 report on Belgium and the Phase 4 two-year follow-up report on Spain. The WGB considered additional follow-up reports from the following countries: Australia, Denmark, Germany, Hungary, Mexico, Norway, Poland, and the United States. The WGB considered the outcomes of the high-level mission to Peru in January 2025 and the hybrid technical and high-level mission to Slovenia in February 2025. In addition, the WGB received updates from countries with Participant status in the WGB on progress to align their legal and institutional frameworks with the requirements of the Convention.³ The WGB heard the Secretariat provide an overview of the OECD Anti-Bribery Convention Country Monitoring Dashboard, an update on the WGB's Programme of Work and Budget (PWB) 2025-2026, and a report on the WGB's Global Relations Strategic Directions (GRSD) 2025-2026. The WGB also received updates from the Chair of the G20 Anti-Corruption Working Group (ACWG), Business at OECD (BIAC), the European Commission (EC), the European Public Prosecutor's Office (EPPO), the Financial Action Task Force (FATF), the Group of States Against Corruption (GRECO), the United Nations Office on Drug and Crime (UNODC), and the World Bank.

Meeting of the Working Group on Bribery, June 2025

The WGB adopted the Phase 4 report on South Africa and the Phase 4 two-year follow-up report on Denmark. The WGB considered additional follow-up reports from the following countries: Brazil, Germany, Hungary, Peru, Poland, Sweden, Türkiye and the United States. The WGB considered the outcomes of the high-level mission to Switzerland in June 2025, heard reports on the informal meeting of law enforcement officials (LEO meeting) and the meeting of the Global Law Enforcement Network (GLEN) in June 2025, and heard an update from the anti-corruption task force of France, Switzerland, and the United Kingdom, established in March 2025. The WGB heard the Secretariat provide updates on the WGB's PWB 2025-2026 and GRSD 2025-2026 and propose revisions to publication practices for public documents. In addition, the WGB undertook a preliminary assessment of Ukraine's request to join the Convention, and

³ WGB Participant status, which in 2025 applied to Mauritius, Ukraine and Saudi Arabia, offers a two-year timeframe for selected countries preparing for accession to the Convention, and which are not otherwise on a pathway to join the OECD.

received updates from Participant countries, including Indonesia, Mauritius, and Saudi Arabia, on progress to align their legal and institutional frameworks with the requirements of the Convention. The WGB also received updates from the Chair of the G20 ACWG, the EC, the EPPO, the FATF, GRECO, UNODC and the World Bank.

Meeting of the Working Group on Bribery, October 2025

The WGB held a virtual intersessional meeting focused on accession to the OECD and to the Convention. The WGB (OECD members) adopted a revised preliminary assessment report on Peru's accession to the OECD and a full assessment regarding Romania's accession to the OECD (see also Chapter 4). The WGB also heard an update on Indonesia's plan to enhance its technical readiness to align with key requirements of the Convention and undertook a full assessment of Ukraine's request to join the Convention.

Meeting of the Working Group on Bribery, December 2025

The WGB adopted the Phase 4 reports on Colombia and Estonia, and the Phase 3 follow-up report on Lithuania. The WGB considered additional follow-up reports from the following countries: Denmark, Finland, Hungary, Japan, Mexico, Peru, Sweden, and the United States. The WGB received updates concerning the high-level mission to Switzerland in June 2025 and the technical mission to Korea in November 2024. The WGB heard the Secretariat provide reports on the December 2025 LEO meeting, the WGB's 1999-2024 enforcement data, and preparations for the 2027-2030 PWB. The WGB (OECD members) undertook a full assessment of Croatia as an OECD accession candidate. The WGB received updates from Participant countries, including Indonesia, Mauritius, Saudi Arabia and Thailand, on progress to align their legal and institutional frameworks with the requirements of the Convention. In addition, the WGB hosted the fifth edition of the Global Dialogue between WGB members and non-member countries (see more below). The WGB also received updates from the OECD Public Governance Directorate on an initiative with the International Transportation Forum (ITF) on organised crime, the Chair of the G20 ACWG, BIAC, the EC, the FATF, GRECO, UNODC and the World Bank.

Meetings of law enforcement officials

Since 2010, LEO meetings have been convened for a full day alongside the WGB's June and December plenary sessions. These meetings are open to law enforcement officials from WGB member countries who play an active role in investigating and prosecuting foreign bribery offences. Officials from WGB Participant countries may also be invited to attend non-confidential sessions. The meetings offer a distinctive forum for practitioners to exchange best practices, explore emerging issues in foreign bribery enforcement, share insights from cases, and build professional networks that enhance cross-border investigations and prosecutions. Participants also contribute to the WGB's thematic work, with the LEO Chair providing oral reports on discussions. These informal meetings are a vital component of the WGB's follow-up and monitoring efforts under the Convention and related instruments.

Main discussion topics of LEO meetings in 2025 were prosecutorial guidelines for non-trial resolutions, specialised police and prosecution cooperation models, holding parent companies liable for bribery acts committed by foreign intermediaries, and fostering resilience among law enforcers handling corruption cases and safeguarding their integrity. LEO meetings also discussed recently concluded foreign bribery cases.

Joint meetings of the WGB and the G20 Anti-Corruption Working Group

The eighth annual joint meeting of the G20 ACWG and the WGB took place during the second G20 ACWG meeting in Brasilia, hosted by Brazil, as co-chair with South Africa of the G20 ACWG in 2025. These joint meetings are held annually in the context of the G20 ACWG to support the shared commitment by these groups to combat the bribery of foreign public officials in international business transactions.

The meeting was opened with high-level remarks by OECD Deputy Secretary-General and Secretary for Private Sector Integrity in the Brazilian Office of the Comptroller General. The first session focused on strengthening the fight against foreign bribery by promoting transparency, integrity, and accountability in law enforcement authorities, with interventions by experts from Brazil, Croatia, France, Romania, and South Africa, along with the WGB Chair. The second session focused on improving the detection of foreign bribery through clearer whistleblower channels and stronger whistleblower protections, with interventions by experts from France, Japan, and the Netherlands. The session was closed by the WGB Chair and G20 ACWG co-chairs.

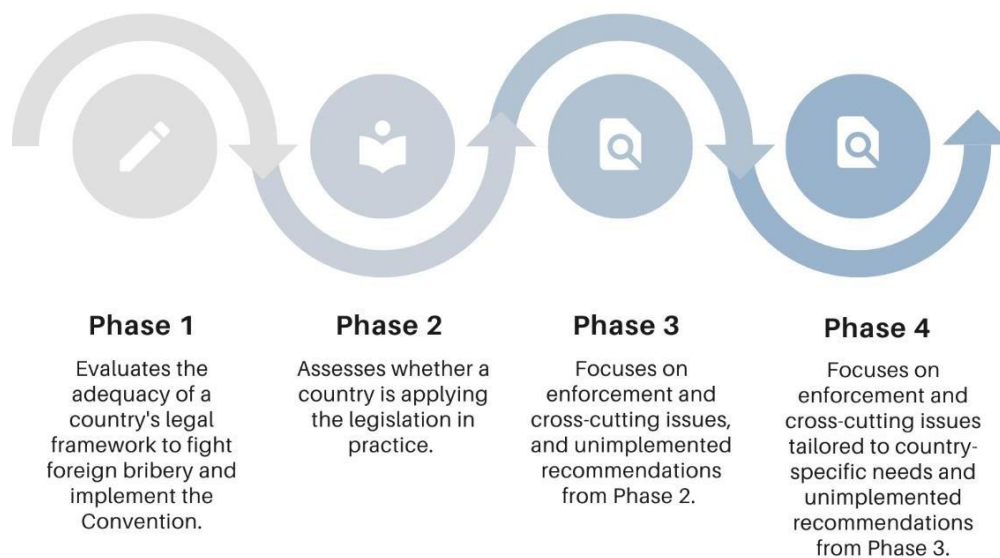
Global Dialogue

Since 2021, the Global Dialogue has provided a forum for peer learning between members and selected non-members of strategic interest to the WGB. It facilitates the exchange of experiences and perspectives on tackling foreign bribery and corruption and helps strengthen global anti-corruption partnerships.

The December 2025 Global Dialogue focused on reporting corruption allegations and whistleblower protection. The event was attended by twelve countries not Party to the Convention: Egypt, Indonesia, Kenya, Malta, Mauritius, Nigeria, Paraguay, the Philippines, Saudi Arabia, Thailand, Ukraine, and Uzbekistan. This platform for peer learning allowed participants to share lessons learned and challenges across diverse legal traditions and approaches to developing and implementing whistleblower protection frameworks in the public and private sectors. Participants discussed how to encourage the reporting of corruption allegations through secure reporting channels, confidentiality, and effective remedies, as well as the potential role of incentives and other measures in promoting a cultural shift in attitudes towards whistleblowing. Discussions also explored, through a real case, how authorities engage with reporting persons during the investigation and prosecution phases, as well as the protection measures that can be applied in practice.

3 Monitoring the OECD Anti-Bribery Convention and the Anti-Bribery Recommendation

The Convention establishes a rigorous peer-review [monitoring system](#) to ensure that Parties fully implement their obligations under its framework. This mandatory monitoring is carried out by the WGB, with experts from each member country serving as examiners. Country monitoring reports present recommendations formed from a thorough assessment, and are discussed, negotiated, and adopted by the WGB during its meetings. The monitoring process is currently structured in four phases:



Phases 2 through 4 include mandatory on-site visits to the country under evaluation, as well as consultations with civil society and the private sector. [Phase 4](#) began in 2016; newer Parties to the Convention may be at an earlier stage in the process (see the [WGB's monitoring schedule 2016–26](#) and its monitoring process brief).

Monitoring is compulsory for all Parties. Reports are adopted on a “consensus-minus-one” basis, meaning that the country under evaluation cannot veto the report’s findings or recommendations. Once adopted, all [country monitoring reports](#), including the WGB’s evaluations and recommendations, are published on the OECD website, accompanied by a press release.

Following the adoption of a country monitoring report, the WGB continues to track the country's progress in implementing the recommendations. If a country fails to take sufficient action, the WGB can employ additional measures. Where appropriate, it may also issue public statements on anti-corruption developments that may affect a Party's compliance with the Convention.

The status of the WGB's application and consideration of additional measures is presented on the OECD's website via the [OECD Anti-Bribery Convention Country Monitoring Dashboard](#), published for the first time in July 2025 and updated regularly. (See Box 3.1) The WGB also tracks Parties' implementation of the Convention through the Tour de Table, where countries report on foreign bribery investigations, prosecutions and sanctions, and via the regular publication of WGB members' enforcement of their foreign bribery frameworks. This data was updated through 2025 and published on the OECD website in January 2026. (See Box 3.2)

Box 3.1. OECD Anti-Bribery Convention Country Monitoring Dashboard

In 2025, the WGB launched the pilot OECD Anti-Bribery Convention Country Monitoring Dashboard. Updated following each of the WGB's plenary meetings, the Dashboard consolidates data on where each of the Parties to the Convention stands in the WGB monitoring process. It shows where countries are subject to additional monitoring measures as a result of inadequate implementation of certain aspects of the Convention. The Dashboard also highlights when a country has been subject to an additional monitoring measure from a concern raised outside of the phased-evaluation reporting process.

[View the dashboard](#)

Box 3.2. Enforcement data of the OECD Anti-Bribery Convention 1999-2024

National data recently collected by the WGB (OECD, 2026^[3]) provides a snapshot of how Parties to the Convention have been enforcing anti-bribery laws since the Convention's entry into force in 1999 through 2024. According to the data:

- Enforcement has continued steadily since 1999 and companies are increasingly the focus, with corporate sanctions and convictions picking up since 2021.
- The annual rate at which new criminal sanctions are applied against individuals has slowed in recent years.
- Enforcement is uneven across countries: Sixteen Parties to the Convention have yet to report a single conviction or sanction for foreign bribery.

The data highlight the gradual progress made by the WGB in implementing the Convention, while also underscoring that further efforts are needed to reduce corruption in business transactions. Parties to the Convention must show leadership by accelerating enforcement, supported by sustained political commitment and adequate financial resources. Companies likewise play a vital role: strong and effective corporate compliance programmes are essential to both preventing bribery and embedding a culture of integrity in decision-making.

Read the blog post: [5 key data insights on how the world's largest economies are combatting international corruption, and what this means for the future](#) (Roussel and Fromholz, 2026^[4])

Source: OECD (2026), "Enforcement data of the OECD Anti-Bribery Convention 1999-2024", OECD Publishing, Paris, <https://doi.org/10.1787/82a562a6-en>.

2025 evaluations and reports

In 2025, Belgium, Colombia, Estonia and South Africa underwent Phase 4 evaluations. Boxes 3.3 to 3.6 below provide an overview of the findings and recommendations from each of these evaluations.

Evaluations were based on legislation, data and other materials provided by each country under evaluation, as well as research conducted by the evaluation team. Information was also obtained during on-site visits, when the evaluation team met representatives of the country's public and private sectors, media, civil society, law enforcement, parliament and academe.

Box 3.3. Belgium Phase 4 Report

The Phase 4 evaluation of Belgium's implementation of the Convention (OECD, 2025^[5]) points out that only three foreign bribery cases have been successfully completed since the Phase 3 evaluation in 2013, resulting in the conviction of five individuals. No companies have been sanctioned in this period.

The report identifies several gaps in Belgium's policy to fight foreign bribery. A lack of financial and human resources at every stage of the enforcement process is a key obstacle to the successful conclusion of cases. Further, Belgian companies are not sufficiently incentivised to implement anti-corruption compliance programmes. Finally, the lack of measures to encourage voluntary disclosure, as well as non-publication of foreign bribery resolutions, also limit effective implementation of the Convention.

The review recognises a range of positive developments since Phase 3, notably the 2024 law that extended the statute of limitations for alleged bribery offences and provided for its interruption upon referral to the trial court. This reform should enable a greater number of foreign bribery cases to be concluded.

The WGB also welcomed reforms ensuring that the liability of companies in Belgium is no longer conditional on the prosecution or conviction of natural persons. It found that the extension of jurisdiction over foreign bribery offences committed abroad should facilitate the prosecution of Belgian companies for acts committed by their subsidiaries abroad. The adoption of a whistleblower protection regime that reflects international standards and incorporates several recognised best practices should enhance the detection of foreign bribery.

To overcome structural obstacles, improve the effectiveness of investigations and prosecutions and strengthen the legal framework, the WGB recommends that Belgium:

- Increase and ring-fence resources allocated to the fight against foreign bribery at every stage of the enforcement process.
- Improve the non-trial resolution mechanism for foreign bribery, including by developing and publishing clear guidelines for prosecutors and practical guides for the private sector.
- Ensure that sanctions are effective, proportionate and dissuasive.
- Publish and make accessible foreign bribery resolutions and decisions.
- Ensure that failure by a company's management to prevent an employee from committing a foreign bribery offence triggers the company's liability.

Belgium will next report to the WGB in March 2027 on its implementation of all recommendations and its enforcement efforts.

[Read the report](#)

Box 3.4. Colombia Phase 4 Report

Colombia's Phase 4 evaluation (OECD, 2025^[6]) notes that Colombia must urgently address longstanding deficiencies in its framework for fighting foreign bribery. The report also expresses concern that the country has progressively disengaged from its obligations under the Convention.

Colombia has achieved its second administrative sanction of a legal person for foreign bribery, but there has never been an attempted prosecution of a natural person, and detection levels are low. Mutual legal assistance mechanisms are uncoordinated and underused, and risks regarding the independence of investigations and prosecutions remain unaddressed. The WGB is also seriously concerned about the longstanding lack of protection for whistleblowers, as well as the significant siloing of agencies responsible for the detection, investigation, and prosecution of foreign bribery.

In addition to the aspects highlighted above, the report details further areas for improvement of Colombia's effectiveness in preventing, detecting, and enforcing the foreign bribery offence. WGB recommendations include:

- Reengaging with the WGB and its work, including where foreign bribery enforcement is concerned.
- Strengthening coordination between key agencies responsible for foreign bribery, including the Office of the Prosecutor General and the Superintendency of Corporations.
- Ensuring that investigations can be opened on the basis of mutual legal assistance requests and proactively share information internally to ensure that all potential allegations arising from mutual legal assistance can be appropriately investigated.
- Urgently implementing a comprehensive whistleblower protection framework.
- Ensuring the independence of investigations and prosecutions.

The report also notes positive developments in Colombia that may contribute to combating foreign bribery. Bancóldex has fully implemented all outstanding recommendations from Phase 2 and 3. Colombia has also established a system of anti-money laundering compliance checks and sanctions against private sector entities which fail to implement these preventive measures, improving the likelihood that reporting entities submit suspicious activities reports diligently and potentially increasing detection of foreign bribery.

Colombia will next report to the WGB in December 2027 on its implementation of all recommendations and its enforcement efforts and will provide an additional report in December 2026 with an action plan to implement five high-priority recommendations.

[Read the report](#)

Box 3.5. Estonia Phase 4 Report

Estonia's Phase 4 evaluation (OECD, 2025^[7]) notes that progress still needs to be made to tackle foreign bribery. Although the country's first convictions for foreign bribery in 2018 marked an important milestone, Estonia has not detected, investigated or prosecuted any other foreign bribery case since the Phase 3 evaluation in 2014.

The WGB found that Estonia's poor enforcement record is not commensurate with the foreign bribery risks faced by Estonian businesses, which results from insufficient awareness and inadequate prioritisation by the authorities. Estonia has not yet comprehensively assessed these risks, and a widespread perception of high integrity in Estonia may contribute to their being downplayed.

While Estonia prioritises combatting corruption, foreign bribery does not receive specific attention. As a result, Estonia does not proactively exploit potential detection sources. In particular, relevant public officials are insufficiently equipped to detect and report foreign bribery allegations and recently introduced whistleblower protections do not clearly apply to foreign bribery.

On a positive note, the WGB welcomed the further specialisation of Estonian authorities in corruption and economic crimes, and the priority given to reinforcing its capacity to confiscate criminal assets. Efficient interagency co-operation and active engagement in international co-operation are other positive features of Estonia's law enforcement mechanisms.

The WGB also acknowledged Estonia's progress since Phase 3 towards bringing its legislative framework into closer alignment with the Convention. The definition of the foreign bribery offence is clearer. The recently revised criminal corporate liability framework potentially introduces important improvements. Sanctions available against legal persons have been significantly increased. However, some key elements of the offence and the corporate liability regime require further clarification, and sanctions may remain insufficient in practice. In addition, issues identified in Phase 3 regarding the rules on the statute of limitations and non-trial resolutions remain unaddressed.

The WGB's recommendations include the following:

- Carrying out a systematic assessment of Estonia's foreign bribery risk profile.
- Proactively gathering information from diverse sources to increase detection of foreign bribery.
- Clarifying legal provisions pertaining to the foreign bribery offence and the new criminal corporate liability framework.
- Clarifying the availability of whistleblower protections to the reporting of foreign bribery.

Estonia will next report to the WGB in December 2027 on its implementation of all recommendations and its enforcement efforts.

[Read the report](#)

Box 3.6. South Africa Phase 4 Report

South Africa has made progress in detecting and investigating foreign bribery cases, despite an undermining of the rule of law and weakening of its law enforcement institutions during a period of state capture.

The Phase 4 evaluation of South Africa's implementation of the Convention (OECD, 2025^[8]) shows that the country has started co-operating with other Parties to the Convention to sanction companies for transnational corruption tied to state capture. The review suggests that the resilience and commitment of individual government and law enforcement officials, working in a multi-agency approach, has contributed to this progress. To consolidate what it has achieved and avoid a repetition of the past, South Africa should now enhance its legal framework and institutional capacity to combat foreign bribery.

South Africa has opened investigations into 18 new foreign bribery allegations since its Phase 3 evaluation in 2014. Authorities have investigated foreign bribery allegations more proactively, using more complex investigative techniques and seeking mutual legal assistance from other countries. In 2019, South Africa started its first foreign bribery court proceedings but still faces enforcement challenges in its 14 ongoing investigations. Authorities need to expand the range of sources used to detect foreign bribery, find better ways to obtain evidence from other countries in the region, and secure sanctions against both companies and individuals.

The WGB welcomed reforms to South Africa's whistleblower legislation. It found that the development of an innovative non-trial resolution mechanism could, with further clarifications, facilitate foreign bribery enforcement. South Africa has also developed public-private partnerships to address capacity issues within law enforcement.

To improve effectiveness in preventing, detecting and enforcing the foreign bribery offence, the WGB recommends that South Africa:

- Hold companies and individuals liable for foreign bribery and related offences.
- Enhance its efforts to promptly detect foreign bribery allegations.
- Better protect whistleblowers who report foreign bribery from retaliation, including financial, professional, and physical harms.
- Ensure more transparent appointments for investigators and prosecutors to prevent the risk of undue influence in foreign bribery cases.
- Increase operational and financial autonomy for the investigators and prosecutors.
- Strengthen its framework for sanctioning foreign bribery with non-trial resolutions.
- Ensure that it has the appropriate framework for sanctioning companies for foreign bribery.

South Africa will next report to the WGB in June 2027 on its implementation of all recommendations and its enforcement efforts.

[Read the report](#)

2025 training activities

In 2025, the Secretariat to the WGB developed and launched a series of training programmes for countries preparing for their Phase 4 review, to further support effective WGB monitoring evaluations. The programme targets key public sector stakeholders, including those responsible for completing evaluation questionnaires and participating in on-site panel discussions. It offers an opportunity to present practical challenges and good practices observed across the WGB, and to discuss country-specific issues at each stage of the evaluation process. In 2025, the Secretariat organised and delivered three virtual training courses attended by approximately 100 experts from Argentina, Colombia, Estonia, Latvia, and the Slovak Republic.

The Secretariat also expanded the training for lead examiners to address Phase 4 challenges and good practices specific to the role. The programme includes practical, scenario-based exercises designed to strengthen the capacities of current and future lead examiners to conduct Phase 4 evaluations, as well as insights from experienced lead examiners involved in past reviews. The training provides both theoretical and hands-on tools to help lead examiners identify foreign-bribery-related gaps, formulate constructive recommendations, and address the very practical questions that arise in planning and conducting an evaluation. In 2025, the Secretariat organised and delivered two virtual lead-examiner training courses for approximately 80 experts from 31 WGB member jurisdictions.

4 Global relations activities

The WGB's GRSD identifies countries both as potential candidates for accession to the Convention and as partners with whom closer engagement would be mutually beneficial. Beyond accession, the WGB aims to build relationships that help strengthen the global fight against foreign bribery. Through this process, the WGB seeks to demonstrate the benefits of engagement with the WGB and to support greater understanding of the Convention, the Anti-Bribery Recommendation and related instruments among non-members.

Expanding membership in the Working Group on Bribery

The WGB continues to expand its global reach and impact, including through welcoming new Parties to the Convention. New members join the WGB through the process of acceding specifically to the Convention, or as part of a broader process of acceding to the OECD, which also involves accession to the Convention. Countries on the path toward accession to the Convention outside of the OECD accession context are first granted Participant status in the WGB, which allows a country two years to undertake the necessary reforms to align with key requirements of the Convention. Participants are expected to contribute substantially to the WGB's mandate and programme of work. OECD accession candidate countries follow a specific multi-step process developed by the WGB.

In 2025, the WGB engaged with both categories of new WGB members: Participants on a path of foreign bribery reform with a view to accession to the Convention and OECD accession candidate countries.

New WGB members and Participants

Mauritius and Saudi Arabia participated in 2025 WGB meetings as Participants.

Mauritius

Mauritius became a Participant in the WGB in 2023, to support its possible accession to the Convention. Since then, Mauritius reported to the WGB at every plenary on progress made to fulfil criteria for accession to the Convention, including on legal reforms that led to the entry into force of the Financial Crimes Commission Act in March 2024. [Mauritius submitted its request for accession to the Convention in May 2025.](#)

Saudi Arabia

Saudi Arabia has been a Participant in the WGB since 2021 and was granted exceptional extensions of its Participant status until March 2026 based on an expected roadmap of reforms, with a view to possible accession to the Convention. Saudi Arabia has regularly reported on progress to the WGB in line with the roadmap. In 2025, the OECD concluded its technical assistance project aimed at helping Saudi Arabia align its legal frameworks with the Convention and related instruments. In addition, Saudi Arabia has undertaken rounds of self-assessment against the Convention and initiated a reform of its Penal Code.

Ukraine

A Participant in the WGB starting in February 2024, [Ukraine requested membership in the WGB and accession to Convention](#) in February 2025. After preliminary and full assessments of Ukraine's request in June and October 2025, the WGB concluded that Ukraine met the criteria for acceding to the Convention and recommended that the OECD Council invite Ukraine to join the WGB. Following an exchange of letters between the OECD Secretary-General and the Government of Ukraine, the country became the 47th WGB member in December 2025. Ukraine is expected to deposit its instrument of accession to the Convention in early 2026.

OECD Anti-Bribery Convention accession for OECD accession candidates

Accession to the Convention is a prerequisite to accession to the OECD.⁴ Of the eight OECD accession candidate countries, Croatia, Indonesia, Romania and Thailand were not parties to the Convention at the time of the opening of their OECD accession discussions.

Croatia and Romania

In 2022, the OECD Council decided to open accession discussions with six countries, including Croatia and Romania, and subsequently adopted their respective Accession Roadmaps, setting out the terms and conditions of the processes.⁵ At that time, Romania and Croatia were not members of the WGB. Having undertaken the necessary legislative reforms to align with key requirements of the Convention, Croatia and Romania completed the process to become Parties to the Convention in 2023. The Convention entered into force on 22 September 2023 for Romania and on 21 January 2024 for Croatia, making them, respectively, the 45th and the 46th Parties to the Convention. In 2025, the WGB undertook assessments in relation to the OECD accession criteria in the field of anti-corruption and concluded that Croatia and Romania are willing and able to implement OECD legal instruments within the WGB's competence and that their anti-corruption policies and practices are aligned with OECD best policies and practices. The OECD Council will consider these countries' accession to the OECD once all technical reviews have concluded.

Indonesia and Thailand

In 2024, the OECD Council decided to open accession discussions with Indonesia and Thailand and subsequently adopted their respective Accession Roadmaps.⁶ [Indonesia submitted its formal request for accession to the Convention in June 2025](#), and [Thailand in December 2025](#).

Since December 2024, Indonesia and Thailand have participated in WGB meetings as OECD accession candidate countries and reported on progress in aligning their legal and institutional frameworks with the requirements of the Convention. In 2025, the WGB engagement with both Indonesia and Thailand focused on providing capacity-building to support their technical readiness to accede to the Convention.

The WGB's engagement with Indonesia started with the implementation of a technical assistance project between October 2024 and March 2025 that included a gap analysis focusing on key requirements for accession to the Convention and a seminar organised in February 2025 with Indonesia's Corruption

⁴ See here for more on the OECD accession process: <https://www.oecd.org/en/about/legal/oecd-accession-process.html>

⁵ See the [Roadmap for the OECD Accession Process of Croatia](#) and the [Roadmap for the OECD Accession Process of Romania](#).

⁶ See the [Roadmap for the OECD Accession Process of Indonesia](#) and the [Roadmap for the OECD Accession Process of Thailand](#).

Eradication Commission, thanks to the financial support of Japan. In August 2025, the OECD Secretariat developed, in coordination with Indonesia, a plan to enhance its readiness to introduce new legislation and improve its institutional and enforcement capability to tackle foreign bribery. The plan benefits from the technical support of several WGB members that participate in the project's Advisory Group as part of a broader effort to pilot a technical assistance facility on WGB anti-bribery standards (see below). Following Thailand's request to accede to the Convention in December 2025, the WGB will engage with Thailand on similar capacity-building initiatives. This work will build on the 2024 assessment of Thailand's legal and policy framework for fighting foreign bribery based on criteria applied to countries seeking accession to the Convention, undertaken in the context of [Thailand's OECD Country Programme](#).

Pilot technical assistance facility

The WGB's pilot technical assistance facility, launched with Indonesia as the first country, is part of a broader effort to establish a strategic approach to supporting countries of interest to the WGB and mobilising relevant expertise to support reform processes. This pilot, supported by the United Kingdom, aims to provide targeted technical assistance to countries of strategic interest to the WGB, helping bring their frameworks closer to WGB anti-bribery standards, particularly in view of accession. It may also support countries that have recently become members of the WGB. The WGB's Subgroup on Global Relations developed a list of countries of strategic interest, mapped their needs through a survey in relation to WGB standards, and established a set of criteria for technical assistance, which will guide the development of the facility.

The Working Group on Bribery's global programmes

This section outlines global programmes funded through voluntary contributions in 2025 that supported implementation of the WGB's GRSD. These programmes focus on two workstreams: strengthening integrity in international business operations and improving co-operation between WGB member and non-member law enforcement authorities to advance effective enforcement of foreign bribery offences.

OECD Business Integrity Roundtables

The OECD Business Integrity Roundtable series serves as a platform for dialogue on evolving business integrity issues in OECD and partner countries. It focuses on innovative elements of the Anti-Bribery Recommendation including collective action against corruption, measures to tackle bribery solicitation, and methodologies for assessing corporate anti-corruption compliance programmes.

A workshop on "Tackling Bribery Solicitation: What Tools for the Private Sector?" convened representatives from the public and private sectors on the margins of the 2025 GACIF, including members of the Anti-Corruption Leaders Hub. The workshop closed with a reflection on avenues to build trust between public and private sector stakeholders to effectively tackle bribery solicitation. Such avenues include establishing more effective reporting channels, fostering industry-oriented initiatives to collect data and support government action, and protecting reporting persons and businesses. More insights are available [here](#).

Box 4.1. Advancing knowledge on business integrity building on the Anti-Bribery Recommendation

The Anti-Bribery Recommendation is the first international standard to recommend collective action as a tool to fight foreign bribery. The 2025 report “[Advancing business integrity through collective action: A blueprint for government support](#)” (OECD, 2025^[9]) explores governments’ role in fostering, facilitating and engaging in collective action initiatives to support the private sector in its fight against corruption. It offers a blueprint for government authorities seeking to support anti-corruption collective action initiatives in ways that are strategic, effective and sustainable. The report was produced with the support of the Basel Institute on Governance in the context of the Siemens Integrity Initiative.

Another topic of the Anti-Bribery Recommendation is the assessment of corporate anti-corruption compliance programmes. The OECD launched two reports on this subject at the Anti-Corruption Leaders Hub meeting on the margins of the 2025 Global Anti-Corruption and Integrity Forum, looking at the roles of governments and companies in assessing anti-corruption compliance programmes:

- [Governments’ assessments of corporate anti-corruption compliance](#) (OECD, 2025^[10]): This report takes stock of existing guidance from public authorities on anti-corruption compliance criteria and assessment methodologies, as well as challenges faced by those authorities to build capacity, resources and access to expertise. It highlights areas where governments can learn from private sector and other stakeholders’ practices, including on the use of data and new technologies. The paper also sets out companies’ recommendations to governments on how to better communicate their expectations regarding anti-corruption compliance programmes, assessment criteria, methodologies and tools.
- [Companies’ assessments of anti-corruption compliance](#) (OECD, 2025^[11]): In the last decade, companies around the globe have significantly invested in the development of anti-corruption compliance programmes. Assessing the effectiveness of these programmes has proven challenging and requires that companies go beyond a box-checking approach, set clear objectives, measure progress and impact, and foster a culture of integrity. This paper takes stock of methodologies and tools – such as key performance indicators, culture surveys, data analytics, audits and peer learning – that companies use to assess and enhance the effectiveness of their anti-corruption programmes.

Global Law Enforcement Network against Transnational Bribery

The Global Law Enforcement Network (GLEN) provides a platform for international co-operation on cross-border cases involving OECD and non-member countries. GLEN meetings are convened annually alongside WGB plenary meetings at the OECD, supporting direct engagement among law enforcement authorities.

The seventh GLEN meeting took place in June 2025 and brought together 103 participants from 49 jurisdictions, including 15 non-WGB member countries, and six partner organisations – the EPPO, Europol, Eurojust, Interpol, UNODC’s Global Operational Network of Anti-Corruption Law Enforcement Authorities (GlobE Network) and the World Bank. The meeting focused on corruption in the defence and security sectors and included a breakout session in which participants explored the intersection between transnational corruption and global threats such as organised crime, cyber-related crime, environmental offences, illicit financial flows, and the complexities of corporate structures.

One objective of GLEN meetings is to facilitate dialogue between practitioners from supply- and demand-side jurisdictions on transnational bribery cases. To this end, the WGB Secretariat helped convene 11 bilateral meetings on the margins of the GLEN, providing a confidential forum for case-related discussions. Discussions like these at the GLEN have led to real enforcement outcomes (see Box 4.2 for one example).

Box 4.2. How proactive law enforcement co-operation inspires new solutions in combating corruption

When co-operation pays off: a landmark corruption settlement coordinated by three countries

In 2025, a French company was fined EUR 18.3 million in a large international corruption case as a result of strong cross-border relationships and institutional co-operation among law enforcement agencies from Ukraine, Estonia and France. The agreement included a requirement to pay around EUR 3.37 million in compensation to Ukraine as a victim of a bribery offence. The company will also implement a three-year anti-corruption compliance programme under the supervision of the French Anti-Corruption Agency (AFA). While the investigation continues, charges have also been filed against several individuals in Estonia and Ukraine, with some entering plea agreements and compensating damage to the Ukrainian budget.

Joining forces and innovative approaches to break new ground

The case is a success story: significant fines, strong action against bribery, and the dismantling of a complex cross-border corruption scheme, thanks to effective co-operation and information sharing between authorities. It sets several important precedents and demonstrates the power of advanced international co-operation mechanisms.

1. Co-ordinated cross-border action

The swift outcome was made possible by co-operation among jurisdictions through a joint investigative team. In 2021, Ukraine's National Anti-Corruption Bureau and Specialised Anti-Corruption Prosecutor's Office launched an investigation into an alleged large-scale embezzlement by the former CEO of a Ukrainian state-owned enterprise. As the investigation unfolded, evidence led to actors in Estonia and France and uncovered elements of money laundering.

Once co-operation was established with Estonia and France, the OECD GLEN was used by Ukrainian authorities to facilitate connections with the French National Financial Prosecutors Office, accelerating the international investigation. All three jurisdictions joined forces in a joint investigation team (JIT), set up with Eurojust, while GLEN meetings provided a platform for informal consultations among JIT members. Ukrainian authorities also received expert support from the World Bank/UNODC Stolen Asset Recovery (StAR) Initiative.

2. Important compensation clause

The compensation to Ukraine is an important aspect of the agreement. The basis for the compensation clause is the loss in tax revenue incurred in Ukraine due to the corruption scheme. It differs from, and in fact complements, a conventional asset recovery mechanism applicable to instrumentalities or proceeds of a crime subject to confiscation.

Strategic use of plea agreements

Another innovative measure was the coordinated use of plea agreements, which strengthened the international investigation. Individuals entering plea agreements in Ukraine assisted and shared valuable information for proceedings in the other participating countries, boosting the overall effectiveness of the cross-border case.

OECD platforms for law enforcement co-operation and peer learning

The case illustrates how opportunities offered by the OECD anti-corruption law enforcement networks benefit the global law enforcement community in the fight against corruption.

The networks, which include the GLEN, the LEO group of the WGB and regional LENs in Asia and the Pacific, Africa, Eastern Europe and Central Asia, and Latin America and the Caribbean, regularly bring together investigators and prosecutors handling transnational corruption cases. The established

process for vetting nominated delegates ensures that only practitioners directly involved in handling cases participate in these meetings.

A recent priority for the GLEN has been to offer its participants more co-operation opportunities and to facilitate tangible progress in ongoing investigations. Over the past three years, the network has been instrumental in:

- assisting countries to launch nine parallel investigations
- establishing seven joint investigative teams
- supporting many other cases through improved evidence gathering and co-ordination.

Beyond casework, the networks also present opportunities for peer learning and open exchanges of emerging law enforcement trends, best practices and new ideas, inspiring innovative approaches.

While the OECD acts as Secretariat to the networks, these initiatives are first and foremost practitioner driven. The achievements of the networks, including the case described here, reflect the strong commitment of the law enforcement community to breaking down barriers and building effective cross-border co-operative frameworks to tackle transnational corruption.

Source: Bonhert, Shcherbai and Fromholz (2025), "How proactive law enforcement co-operation inspires new solutions in combating corruption", OECD Publishing, Paris, <https://www.oecd.org/en/blogs/2025/10/how-proactive-law-enforcement-co-operation-inspires-new-solutions-in-combating-corruption.html>

The Working Group on Bribery's regional programmes

The WGB has regional programmes in Africa, Asia and the Pacific, Eastern Europe and Central Asia, and Latin America and the Caribbean. These programmes contribute to creating wider engagement for anti-bribery reforms across the world.

Anti-Corruption Network for Eastern Europe and Central Asia

Established in 1998, the Anti-Corruption Network for Eastern Europe and Central Asia ([ACN](#)) brings together 24 countries, including eight WGB members: Bulgaria, Croatia, Estonia, Latvia, Lithuania, Romania, Slovenia, and Ukraine. The ACN supports its member countries⁷ in preventing and combating corruption, offering a forum for exchanging good practices and promoting anti-corruption reforms. Under the [Istanbul Anti-Corruption Action Plan](#) (IAP), launched in 2003, the ACN carries out comprehensive peer reviews of member countries. To promote peer learning and regional co-operation, the ACN has developed thematic programmes, including the Law Enforcement Network (LEN) and the Business Integrity Group, and supports member countries through country-level projects to strengthen their anti-corruption frameworks.

The 2025 ACN plenary and fifth round of IAP monitoring follow-up reports

The [annual ACN plenary](#) was held in July 2025 and included the 24th IAP monitoring meeting and 30th ACN Steering Group meeting. Nearly 170 participants attended in person and online, including ACN national coordinators from 20 countries, as well as representatives of international organisations and civil society. Key outcomes of the meetings included: (i) the approval of follow-up monitoring reports for Armenia

⁷ These are Albania, Armenia, Azerbaijan, Bosnia and Herzegovina, Bulgaria, Croatia, Estonia, Georgia, Kazakhstan, Kosovo*, the Kyrgyz Republic, Latvia, Lithuania, North Macedonia, Moldova, Mongolia, Montenegro, Romania, Serbia, Slovenia, Tajikistan, Turkmenistan, Ukraine and Uzbekistan.

(OECD, 2025^[12]), Azerbaijan (OECD, 2025^[13]), Moldova (OECD, 2025^[14]) and Ukraine (OECD, 2025^[15]) under the [fifth round of IAP monitoring](#), which were subsequently released in September; and (ii) the expansion of the IAP monitoring programme, as the Steering Group welcomed Montenegro and Bosnia and Herzegovina as new IAP members. The Steering Group meeting also featured the second [Regional Policy Dialogue Session](#), which focused on public policy measures to promote integrity in business operations, drawing on the findings of [Anti-Corruption Trends in Eastern Europe and Central Asia: Strategic Frameworks and Business Integrity](#) (OECD, 2025^[16]).

The ACN Law Enforcement Network

The 15th ACN Law Enforcement Network (LEN) meeting took place in November 2025 in Bucharest, Romania and was hosted by Romania's National Anti-Corruption Directorate. The meeting brought together 73 participants from 29 jurisdictions, including 14 WGB member countries and four partner organisations – the EPPO, Europol, the International Anti-Corruption Coordination Centre (IACCC) and the World Bank. The meeting addressed key issues related to the investigation and prosecution of complex corruption cases, including the use of confiscation measures, effective financial investigations, high-level corruption and co-operation between the EU and Eastern Partnership countries. Additionally, 11 bilateral meetings between participating countries or international organisations were held, allowing parties to confidentially discuss ongoing cross-border corruption investigations and next steps to advance co-operation.

The ACN matrix of allegations of high-level corruption

The ACN's matrix of allegations of high-level corruption is a compendium of allegations of high-level corruption in ACN countries collected by the Secretariat from public sources. The matrix serves as an analytical tool to inform evidence-based analysis and capacity-building work for law enforcement in the region. In November 2025, the OECD Council approved a mandate revision authorising the ACN to process personal data for its work on the matrix. The full version of the matrix will be launched in spring 2026.

Uzbekistan country project

Launched in October 2024, this project supported IAP monitoring in Uzbekistan by providing in-depth analytical input and follow-up support, which resulted in a roadmap to enhance compliance with IAP standards, formalised via endorsement by the National Anti-Corruption Council of Uzbekistan. The project facilitated multi-stakeholder dialogue by co-organising discussions in 2025 on whistleblower protection, transparency in public procurement and the role of the Business Ombudsman, thereby strengthening key pillars of the national integrity system and improving the environment for clean business.

Anti-Corruption Initiative for Asia and the Pacific

Founded in 1999 by the Asian Development Bank (ADB) and the OECD, the [Anti-Corruption Initiative for Asia and the Pacific](#) (ACI) brings together 35 countries in the region,⁸ including four WGB countries: Australia, Japan, Korea, and New Zealand. The ACI advances anti-corruption efforts through three OECD-led workstreams: the Law Enforcement Network (LEN), which facilitates co-operation among law enforcement practitioners; the Business Integrity Network (BIN), which connects stakeholders, promotes

⁸ These are Afghanistan; Australia; Azerbaijan; Bangladesh; Bhutan; Cambodia; the People's Republic of China; Cook Islands; Fiji Islands; Georgia; Hong Kong (China); India; Indonesia; Japan; Kazakhstan; Korea; the Kyrgyz Republic; Macau (China); Malaysia; Mongolia; Nepal; New Zealand; Pakistan; Palau; Papua New Guinea; the Philippines; Samoa; Singapore; the Solomon Islands; Sri Lanka; Thailand; Timor-Leste; Uzbekistan, Vanuatu; and Viet Nam.

good business practices, and supports collective action; and the Public Integrity Network (PIN), supported by the OECD Public Governance Directorate.

The ACI's 12th Regional Conference was organised under the theme "Integrity to catalyse social development and economic growth". It included a meeting of the ACI Steering Group, bringing together senior representatives from the ACI's 35 member countries to discuss the ACI's future priorities and directions, along with a series of thematic sessions and workshops. These included two high-level plenary sessions followed by workshops on integrity and anti-corruption in the public and private sectors, as well as workshops on the OECD Public Integrity Indicators and relevant initiatives of the Anti-Corruption Leaders Hub. In addition, an ACI LEN meeting provided a forum for investigators, prosecutors, and other law enforcement practitioners to exchange experiences on overcoming the challenges of transnational corruption, particularly those involving intermediaries and cryptocurrencies, with discussions focusing on co-operation across national and regional law enforcement agencies and the role of networks such as the IACCC "Women Against Transnational Corruption Hub" initiative.

Joint OECD/African Development Bank Initiative to Support Business Integrity and Anti-Bribery Efforts in Africa

Since 2008, the OECD and the African Development Bank (AfDB) have partnered to support African governments in combating bribery and corruption. The [Joint Initiative](#) supports its 21 member countries⁹ in strengthening corporate integrity and accountability, while promoting a business environment attractive to foreign investment. In 2024, the African anti-corruption LEN (AFR LEN) was launched. The AfDB and OECD act as co-secretariat to the AFR LEN, which is co-chaired by Mauritius and South Africa.

In April 2025, the OECD and AfDB, in co-ordination with the World Bank's Integrity Vice Presidency, held a one-day AFR LEN workshop as a side meeting of the Partnerships for Anti-corruption Global Forum hosted by the World Bank Group. The AFR LEN meeting brought together 34 law enforcement officials from 15 African jurisdictions as well as representatives from several international organisations. The workshop provided an opportunity to discuss practical experience on international co-operation in foreign bribery and transnational corruption matters, through practical case studies presented by its members.

In November 2025, a virtual seminar entitled "A Dual Track Approach to Enhancing Anti-corruption Investigations: Lessons from Parallel Civil and Criminal Proceedings" took place within the framework of the AFR LEN. Members of Kenya's Ethics and Anti-corruption Commission presented a case study on this topic, which was followed by an interactive discussion with AFR LEN practitioners. The webinar was attended by 50 law enforcement practitioners across nine African jurisdictions, as well as investigators from the World Bank and the AfDB's integrity and sanctions units. The next AFR LEN meeting will be hosted by the AfDB and take place in Abidjan, Cote D'Ivoire, in April 2026, and will focus on financial investigations in corruption cases.

OECD-Latin America and Caribbean Anti-Corruption Initiative

Established in 2007 with support from the Inter-American Development Bank and the Organization of American States, the [OECD-Latin America and Caribbean Anti-Corruption Initiative](#) promotes the Convention in the region and aims to strengthen its implementation. The Initiative provides WGB members¹⁰ and non-members with a forum to exchange experiences, identify good practices, and address shared challenges in combating corruption.

⁹ These are Benin, Burkina Faso, Cameroon, Ethiopia, Ghana, Kenya, Madagascar, Malawi, Mali, Mauritania, Mozambique, Namibia, Niger, Nigeria, Rwanda, Senegal, Sierra Leone, South Africa, Tanzania, Uganda and Zambia.

¹⁰ These are Argentina, Brazil, Chile, Colombia, Costa Rica, Mexico and Peru.

The LEN for Latin America and the Caribbean (LAC LEN) provides a forum for law enforcement officials in the region to exchange experiences and learn from peers on topics such as international co-operation, investigative techniques, evaluation of compliance programmes, use of new technologies and inter-agency co-operation. It benefits from the active involvement of members of the WGB, including Brazil and Costa Rica, which are serving as LAC LEN co-chairs. The next LAC LEN meeting will take place in Brasilia, Brazil, in February 2026 and will focus on fighting transnational corruption as an enabler of organised crime.

Anti-Corruption and Promotion of Business Integrity in the Middle East and North Africa

While the WGB does not have an outreach programme for the Middle East and North Africa (MENA), WGB members have engaged in the context of broader OECD engagement of with the region, in co-operation with the [MENA-OECD Initiative on Governance and Competitiveness for Development](#).¹¹

The OECD has continued to provide strategic support to governments in strengthening anti-corruption frameworks at country level, in both Egypt and Saudi Arabia. The OECD-Egypt Country Programme included a gap analysis review regarding Egypt's framework on the liability of legal persons against the standards of the Convention and the Anti-Bribery Recommendation, as well as two risk-mapping notes focused on the health and agriculture sectors, both delivered in December 2025. Anti-corruption workshops on corporate liability and collective action were also held in Cairo in April and November 2025.

In addition to the WGB's technical support to support Saudi Arabia in aligning its legal frameworks with the Convention, the OECD facilitated dialogue between public and private sectors to foster business integrity in the framework of the project on "Fair Market Conditions for Competitiveness" supported by Siemens Integrity Initiative.

At the regional level, the MENA-OECD Business Integrity Network (MOBIN), which is co-chaired by Morocco and France, promotes public-private dialogue on advancing business integrity and anti-corruption efforts through practical, collaborative approaches in the region. The network met on the margins of the 11th Conference of the States Parties to the United Nations Convention Against Corruption (UNCAC CoSP) in Doha, Qatar, in December 2025 to exchange good practices and challenges in "Strengthening Business Integrity: Collective Action and Risk Assessment in the MENA Region".

A capacity-building training was also held at the International Monetary Fund Regional Centre in Kuwait on "Detection of Corruption in the MENA Region: How to Overcome the Challenges?" in April 2025.

¹¹ The MENA-OECD Initiative covers Algeria, Bahrain, Djibouti, Egypt, Iraq, Jordan, Kuwait, Lebanon, Libya, Mauritania, Morocco, Oman, the Palestinian Authority, Qatar, Saudi Arabia, Tunisia, the United Arab Emirates and Yemen.

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